

ZHAO-CEN JIAN

簡兆岑 | Critical Heritage Studies & Infrastructure Research

r14544007@ntu.edu.tw · jianzhaocen.github.io · Taipei, Taiwan

EDUCATION

National Taiwan University (NTU) — M.A. Student, Graduate Institute of Building and Planning 2024 – Present
National Taiwan University (NTU) — B.A. in Sociology 2020 – 2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Critical Heritage Studies and Infrastructure
- Development Sociology
- Science and Technology Studies (STS)
- Urban Development and Housing Justice
- Indigenous Studies
- Qualitative Research and Ethnography

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Master's Thesis — From Urban Discard to Rural Bricolage: Retired Bike-Sharing Infrastructure and the Reproduction of Mobility Injustice in Taiwan 2025 – Present

- Examines how decommissioned urban bike-sharing infrastructure is repurposed in rural contexts, tracing how discarded mobility systems are re-signified and re-valued — connecting infrastructure studies with questions of heritage-making and value transformation.

Independent Study — Hybrid Entanglements of Cultural Heritage: Vertical Politics and Archaeology beneath Taoyuan Railway Station 2026

- Site: Taoyuan Railway Station redevelopment, Taiwan — a mass-transit and railway undergrounding project that unearthed Qing-dynasty rail bed remains, Japanese-colonial-era station structures, and a Neolithic (Xuntangpu culture) archaeological layer.
- Focus: analyzes the “vertical politics” of cultural heritage governance in infrastructure development, drawing on Wang & Huang's (2018) concepts of latecomer anxiety and face-saving projects, and Brian Larkin's (2013) infrastructural poetics, to explain the rapid backfilling of the archaeological site.
- Methods: document and policy analysis, media/discourse analysis, and comparative case study (Taichung, Amsterdam, Rome, Seoul, Sannai-Maruyama); interviews with heritage-review committee members and site visits are planned for a subsequent research stage and have not yet been conducted.

PUBLICATIONS

簡兆岑等（2026）。〈消失的路，失蹤的家：當我們在永春街，用身體撬動一場街道倡議〉。《眼底城事》，2026 年 7 月 20 日。

The Vanishing Road, the Missing Home: Mobilizing a Street Advocacy Campaign on Yongchun Street through the Body. Eyes on Place. eyesonplace.net/2026/07/20/30370

Group research report (co-authored); public-facing publication of the Yongchun Street mobility-vulnerability studio project.

簡兆岑（2026）。〈誰的地方創生？從淡路島看企業、科技與地方生活的交織〉。《城鄉通訊》，投稿審查中。

Reflection on a June 2026 field program (NTU x Pasona Group) on Awaji Island, examining corporate-led place-making, Avatar telepresence technology and labor inclusion, and adaptive reuse of a decommissioned school.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

18th Asian Planning Schools Association (APSA) Congress 2026, The University of Hong Kong Fall 2026

Accepted Oral Presentation, Transportation and Infrastructure track — "The Second Life of Technological Artifacts: Maintenance, Repair, and Rebirth of Retired Public Bicycles"

International Forum on Urbanism (IFoU) 2026, Beijing, China Fall 2026
Accepted Oral Presentation, Heritage as Resistance: Re-imagining Inclusive Heritage as a Strategic Tool Against Demolition-Oriented Redevelopment in Yongchun Street, Taipei

Kobe University Academic Presentation, Japan 2025
Differences in political attitudes between Taiwanese and Japanese university students And the background behind those differences

National University of Singapore (NUS), Short-Term Program, Singapore Fall 2025
"From "Kampong" to "City in Nature": The Story of Chickens"

INTERNATIONAL ACADEMIC EXPERIENCES

Utrecht Summer School, Netherlands Summer 2026
Dutch Cultural Heritage: Art and History · Dutch Culture: Society and Current Issues

Awaji Island Field Traineeship, Japan Summer 2026

National University of Singapore (NUS), Short-Term Exchange Program, Singapore Fall 2025

WORKSHOPS AND ACADEMIC TRAINING

22nd Anthropology Camp — “Sensory Body and Design” (身體感與設計), Institute of Ethnology, Academia Sinica 2026

WORK AND INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Department of Geography, National Taiwan University Fall 2025 – Present

Private Tutor 2024 – Present

Intern, Taiwan Labour Front Summer 2023

Teacher Training Program, HumanEd Foundation (HEF) Spring 2023

Intern, Taiwan Labour Front Summer 2022

Service Intern, Homeless Persons Support, Lonely Person's Canteen (浪人食堂) 2021 – 2022

RESEARCH METHODS

– Ethnography	– In-depth Interviews
– Participant Observation	– Field Notes Analysis
– Social Statistics	– Document / Policy Analysis

LANGUAGES

– Chinese — Native

– English — Academic Working Proficiency (standardized test score in progress)

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

– Ranked First in Admission, NTU Graduate Institute of Building and Planning

– Accepted Presentation, IFoU 2026

– Award of Excellence (優選獎), 21st National Planning Internship Exhibition — Urban Renewal Innovation Award (2026)